

Personal Expense Tracker – Write up

This project was about creating a personal expense tracker in Python. In this project it allowed for the user to add, view, track expenses while comparing it to the monthly budget which the user inputs. Users can also save and load expense data connected to a CSV file.

Step 1: I created a function that lets the user enter a date, category, and amount of expense. I also added a section for the user to add a short description of an expense and this is stored in a dictionary inside and list.

Step 2: I created a function that prints out each expense that the user has added, and I did it in a list format which helped me to make sure that data was being saved properly.

Step 3: I created two functions

- One to let the user enter how much they want to spend this month, in other words let them set an amount for a budget
- Another was to add up the total expense so far and compare it to their budget – I also included if spending goes over a budget it shows some time of warning

Step 4: I created a function to save all expense data to a file called 'expense.csv'. I also made sure to add a function that loads the saved expense back into the list when the program starts – so that way the user does not lose their data when they close their program

Step 5: I created a “menu” using a while loop showing 5 options (1 - add expense; 2 - view expense; 3 - track budget; 4 - save expense; 5 - exit). Depending on what the user types, it will run the corresponding function and the program will keep running until the user hits option 5 which means they are choosing to exit the program.

Reflection:

This project helped me reinforce my knowledge in functions (def), lists, dictionaries, file handling, and loops to create a simple tracking system. The step by step breakdown helped me understand what each part of the code was doing and how it built on the previous step.